

01

SĀṂKHYA

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

A February 2026 academic lecture on Puruṣa and Prakṛti is educational context only. □□ Inference: Contemporary mind–body comparisons may clarify the doctrine, but must not be presented as official adoption or as evidence for classical metaphysics.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: A February 2026 academic lecture on Puruṣa and Prakṛti is educational context only. □□ Inference: Contemporary mind–body comparisons may clarify the doctrine, but must not be presented as official adoption or as evidence for classical metaphysics.

02

SĀṂKHYA: CORE DISTINCTIONS

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Exam use. □□ This epistemology is the hinge of the whole system: because mūla-prakṛti (root Prakṛti) and puruṣa are not sense-objects, Sāṃkhya must show how they can still be known without multiplying pramāṇas.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Master verdict: Sāṃkhya is a realist dualism and evolutionism: Prakṛti transforms, Puruṣa witnesses, and liberation occurs through discriminating their radical difference.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Conclusion. □□ Therefore the five arguments for Prakṛti and the arguments for Puruṣa are not rhetorical flourishes; they discharge an epistemological obligation created by Sāṃkhya's own three-pramāṇa scheme.

ANSWER LINE: “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) is a realist dualism in which three pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) establish one unconscious Prakṛti (primordial material nature) and many conscious Puruṣas (pure witnesses).”.